
HDFC Bank

Investment Analysis

Date: 15 March 2026

This analysis is based on training data through mid-2025. Figures should be verified against the most recent filings.

1. Business History

HDFC Bank traces its origins to the post-liberalisation wave that reshaped Indian finance. In 1994, the Reserve Bank of India issued new private banking licences for the first time in decades, and Housing Development Finance Corporation Ltd (HDFC Ltd) — India's pioneering housing finance company, founded in 1977 by Hasmukhbhai Parekh — seized the opportunity. Under the strategic direction of HDFC Ltd chairman Deepak Parekh, the subsidiary was incorporated in August 1994 and commenced operations in January 1995 with its first branch in Ramon House, Mumbai. Parekh recruited Citibank veteran Aditya Puri as managing director, a choice that would define the institution's trajectory for over a quarter century.

Puri's early strategic bet was contrarian for the era: he oriented the bank toward retail banking and technology infrastructure at a time when most Indian banks remained branch-heavy, paper-driven operations focused on corporate lending. HDFC Bank was among the first Indian banks to deploy core banking solutions across all branches, enabling real-time processing and a consistent customer experience that became a competitive moat. The bank launched its credit card business in the late 1990s and moved aggressively into auto loans, personal loans, and two-wheeler financing — segments that incumbents like State Bank of India were slow to professionalise.

Growth was accelerated through two significant acquisitions. In February 2000, HDFC Bank merged with Times Bank Ltd, a younger private bank promoted by the Times of India group, which added branches and a customer base at relatively low cost. More transformative was the May 2008 acquisition of Centurion Bank of Punjab, itself the product of an earlier merger between Centurion Bank and Bank of Punjab. This deal added roughly 400 branches, many in northern and southern India, providing geographic diversification and accelerating HDFC Bank's semi-urban and rural penetration.

Throughout Puri's tenure, which lasted until his retirement in October 2020, the bank's cultural DNA crystallised around three principles: conservative credit underwriting with gross NPA ratios consistently among the lowest in the Indian banking sector (typically 1.2–1.4% even through stress cycles), sustained technology investment, and rigorous cost discipline that kept the cost-to-income ratio below 40% for most years. Puri was succeeded by Sashidhar Jagdishan, a career HDFC Bank insider who had served as CFO.

The most consequential event in the bank's recent history was the merger with parent HDFC Ltd, announced in April 2022 and effective 1 July 2023. This landmark transaction — the largest in Indian corporate history at the time — collapsed the holding-company structure, absorbing HDFC Ltd's approximately Rs 6 lakh crore mortgage book directly onto the bank's balance sheet. The rationale was multi-layered: HDFC Ltd's wholesale-funded mortgage portfolio would benefit from access to HDFC Bank's low-cost CASA deposit base, while the bank gained a dominant position in housing finance, India's fastest-growing retail credit segment. The merged entity immediately became the fourth-largest bank globally by market capitalisation. However, the integration introduced near-term challenges — a temporarily elevated loan-to-deposit ratio above 110%, the need to build incremental deposits of several lakh crore to normalise that ratio, and the absorption of HDFC Ltd's higher-cost borrowings that compressed net interest margins into the 3.4–3.6% range during the transition period.

The bank's current form — a universal banking franchise with approximately 8,000 branches, a Rs 25 lakh crore-plus balance sheet, a market-leading credit card portfolio exceeding 20 million cards, and the largest private-sector mortgage book in India — is the cumulative product of Parekh's founding vision, Puri's execution discipline, two well-timed acquisitions, a technology-first operating philosophy, and the transformative reabsorption of its own parent.

2. Management & Incentives

HDFC Bank has been led by CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan since October 2020, succeeding the legendary Aditya Puri, who built the bank from its 1994 inception into India's largest private-sector lender by market capitalisation. Jagdishan is a career HDFC Bank insider — he joined in 1996 and served as CFO from 2008 to 2020, giving him deep institutional knowledge but a markedly different profile from Puri's founder-operator persona. CFO Srinivasan Vaidyanathan, who stepped into the role upon Jagdishan's elevation, has similarly been a long-tenured institutional figure. Kaizad Bharucha serves as Executive Director overseeing wholesale banking, and Bhavesh Zaveri handles operations and technology — both are internal veterans.

The Puri-to-Jagdishan transition was closely watched by markets given Puri's outsized stature. The RBI approved Jagdishan's appointment for a three-year term, subsequently renewed. The transition was orderly — a credit to the board's planning — but the stock initially underperformed as investors assessed whether Jagdishan could sustain Puri's execution discipline. He has since largely proven himself, maintaining asset quality through the COVID cycle and steering the transformative merger with parent HDFC Ltd. Key-person risk has meaningfully diminished relative to the Puri era, as the institution is now less identified with a single individual.

Pre-merger, HDFC Ltd held approximately 21% of HDFC Bank's equity, providing a concentrated, long-term anchor shareholder. Post-merger, this promoter stake was effectively extinguished as HDFC Ltd ceased to exist as a separate entity. Institutional ownership is dominant — foreign institutional investors hold roughly 33–35% and domestic mutual funds approximately 25–28%. Executive shareholding is modest in absolute terms; Jagdishan's direct stake is not material enough to constitute significant skin in the game, though ESOPs form a meaningful component of senior management compensation.

Executive pay is regulated by the RBI. Jagdishan's total compensation has been in the range of INR 7–10 crore annually, with a significant variable component tied to performance metrics including ROA, asset quality, and loan growth. This structure is reasonably well-aligned with shareholder interests, though the variable component is less aggressive than global peers.

Management has maintained a conservative dividend payout ratio, typically 20–25% of net profit, prioritising internal capital generation to fund 18–22% loan growth. Capital raises have been infrequent and well-timed — the 2020 QIP of approximately INR 15,000 crore was executed near reasonable valuations. Post-merger, the bank is digesting HDFC Ltd's lower-margin mortgage book and optimising the combined balance sheet's funding mix, gradually replacing HDFC Ltd's wholesale borrowings with retail deposits. Management guided this transition would take 2–3 years; early progress has been broadly on track, though net interest margins compressed as expected.

The board maintains a majority of independent directors, consistent with SEBI and RBI requirements. Atanu Chakraborty serves as Part-Time Chairman. Board tenure and composition have been refreshed periodically, avoiding entrenchment.

Historically, HDFC Bank's management has been among the most reliable in Indian banking at delivering on stated targets. Under Puri, the bank almost never missed consensus on asset quality or growth. Jagdishan has maintained this discipline, with one notable exception: the technology-related outages in 2020–2021 that drew an RBI ban on new digital launches, revealing operational gaps that management had underappreciated. On the merger integration, management's communicated timeline and margin trajectory have been broadly credible, reinforcing confidence in forward guidance.

3. Competitive Landscape

India's banking sector is a three-tier competitive arena: state-owned public sector undertakings (PSUs) commanding roughly 58–60% of system deposits but burdened by legacy inefficiencies; private-sector banks capturing a steadily rising share through superior execution; and a rapidly scaling cohort of fintechs and new-age financial entities that are unbundling specific verticals. HDFC Bank operates at the apex of the private-sector tier, and the merger with HDFC Ltd cemented its position as the largest private bank in the world by market capitalisation outside China.

ICICI Bank is the closest structural peer, having undergone its own multi-year cleanup under Sandeep Bakhshi and now posting ROAs above 2.2%, narrowing the profitability gap with HDFC Bank. Kotak Mahindra Bank maintains a premium CASA ratio above 50% but operates at roughly one-quarter of HDFC Bank's balance-sheet scale. Axis Bank, post its Citi India consumer acquisition, has bolstered its cards and wealth franchise but continues to trail on asset quality consistency. SBI, the PSU behemoth, holds approximately 23% of system deposits and dominates government and rural flows, though its return on equity lags private peers by 400–500 basis points. Bajaj Finance, while technically an NBFC, competes aggressively in consumer and SME lending.

HDFC Bank's moat rests on several reinforcing pillars. Its deposit franchise spans over 8,500 branches across semi-urban and rural India, providing a low-cost funding base reflected in a CASA ratio that, pre-merger, hovered near 45–47%. This translates directly into a cost-of-funds advantage of 30–50 basis points versus most peers. Underwriting discipline is evident in gross NPA ratios consistently below 1.3% through cycles, compared to 3–6% for PSU banks. Technology investment has been substantial: the bank processes over 400 million transactions monthly on its digital platform.

These advantages are durable but not impregnable. The UPI ecosystem, processing over 12 billion transactions monthly, has commoditised payments — PhonePe and Google Pay together hold roughly 80% share, marginalising bank-branded payment apps. Jio Financial Services, backed by Reliance's 450-million-user digital ecosystem, represents a credible medium-term threat in digital lending and insurance distribution. Digital lending platforms collectively originated over Rs 1.5 lakh crore in FY2024, diverting flow from traditional bank channels.

HDFC Bank commands approximately 10–11% of system deposits post-merger and roughly 14–15% of outstanding credit card volumes, making it the largest issuer in India. Banking licence scarcity (the RBI has issued no new universal bank licences since 2015), the decades required to build depositor trust, and the cost of physical distribution infrastructure create formidable entry barriers. However, regulatory evolution — particularly the RBI's digital lending guidelines and potential for differentiated licence categories — could incrementally lower these barriers for well-capitalised technology firms.

4. Financial Characteristics

HDFC Bank's financial profile is distinguished by a rare combination of growth, profitability, and asset quality discipline that has few parallels among large-cap banks globally, though the July 2023 merger with parent HDFC Ltd has introduced a transitional period that temporarily obscures these structural advantages.

Net interest income constitutes roughly 70–75% of total revenue, with the remainder drawn from fees, commissions, and trading gains. The retail segment contributes approximately 50–55% of advances, with wholesale banking and treasury accounting for the balance. Historically, HDFC Bank sustained net interest margins in the range of 4.0–4.1%, among the highest for any Indian bank of comparable scale. Post-merger, NIMs compressed toward the 3.4–3.6% range as HDFC Ltd's wholesale-oriented, lower-yielding mortgage book was absorbed. Management has guided toward gradual NIM recovery as higher-cost legacy borrowings mature and are replaced with lower-cost deposit funding.

Pre-merger, HDFC Bank consistently delivered return on assets of approximately 1.9–2.0% and return on equity of 16–17%, metrics that placed it in the top decile of global commercial banks. The merger mechanically diluted both ratios — ROA dipped toward 1.6–1.7% and ROE toward 14–15% — owing to the enlarged asset base. The trajectory back toward pre-merger profitability is contingent on deposit mobilisation and the run-down of HDFC Ltd's high-cost bond liabilities.

Gross NPA ratios have been maintained at approximately 1.2–1.3%, with provision coverage consistently above 70%. This is notably superior to the Indian banking sector average of 3–4% gross NPAs and reflects conservative underwriting, particularly in the unsecured retail book.

The current account and savings account ratio of roughly 45–47% underpins a structural cost-of-funds advantage. Post-merger, the loan-to-deposit ratio elevated to approximately 105–110%, above the bank's historical comfort zone of 85–90%, necessitating aggressive deposit gathering now underway.

Total assets post-merger exceed \$350 billion, making HDFC Bank the largest private-sector bank in India by a considerable margin. Capital adequacy remains comfortable at roughly 18–19%. The loan book has compounded at approximately 18–20% annually over the past decade. The cost-to-income ratio of around 40% reflects operational efficiency that compares favourably to both Indian peers (typically 45–55%) and most global banks of similar scale.

The critical normalisation tasks are threefold: reducing the loan-to-deposit ratio toward 85–90% through sustained deposit growth, meeting priority sector lending requirements that HDFC Ltd was previously exempt from, and replacing approximately \$30–40 billion in high-cost HDFC Ltd borrowings as they mature over the next two to three years.

What is genuinely distinctive is the coexistence of scale, growth, and risk discipline. Among global banks with assets exceeding \$300 billion, very few sustain sub-1.5% gross NPAs alongside mid-teens loan growth and near-2% ROA.

5. Red Flags

The July 2023 merger with HDFC Ltd created India's largest private-sector bank by assets, but the integration arithmetic is far less flattering than headline numbers suggest. HDFC Ltd brought approximately Rs 6 lakh crore in home loans alongside a liability franchise built on wholesale funding — bonds, commercial paper, and NHB refinance — carrying materially higher costs than HDFC Bank's granular retail deposit base. The loan-to-deposit ratio spiked above 110% post-merger, a level management itself has acknowledged will take two to three years to normalise toward the pre-merger ~85–87% range. Every quarter of elevated LDR is a quarter of compressed net interest margins.

Then there is the priority sector lending shortfall. HDFC Ltd, as a non-bank, had no PSL obligation. HDFC Bank must now meet PSL targets on a vastly enlarged balance sheet, with a phase-in window that still imposes significant costs. Shortfalls are parked in lower-yielding RIDF deposits with NABARD or met through purchase of PSL certificates — either route is a direct drag on return on assets.

The RBI's December 2020 action — barring HDFC Bank from issuing new credit cards and launching digital initiatives after repeated technology outages — was an unprecedented public rebuke of a supposedly best-in-class franchise. The ban lasted roughly eight months and cost the bank measurable market share in credit cards, a segment Kotak, ICICI, and SBI Cards exploited aggressively. The episode revealed an underinvestment in core technology infrastructure that contradicted the premium valuation narrative.

More broadly, the RBI has been tightening the screws on unsecured lending across the system, raising risk weights on consumer credit and bank lending to NBFCs by 25 percentage points in November 2023. HDFC Bank's unsecured retail book — personal loans, credit cards — is not immune. Higher risk weights consume more capital per rupee lent, mechanically lowering returns on equity.

Aditya Puri ran HDFC Bank for twenty-six years with an autocratic clarity that markets rewarded with a persistent valuation premium. Sashidhar Jagdishan, his successor since October 2020, inherited a well-oiled machine but has presided over a period defined less by strategic initiative than by the sheer gravitational complexity of the merger. The bank's stock de-rated from roughly 4x price-to-book pre-COVID to closer to 2.5–3x — a verdict that reflects, at minimum, market uncertainty about whether the institution retains its founder-era edge. Investors should ask whether Jagdishan is architecting HDFC Bank's next decade or merely administering its last one.

India's consumer credit boom has been fueled by rising digital adoption and post-COVID revenge spending. HDFC Bank's credit card and personal loan portfolios grew rapidly through FY23–24, but asset quality in unsecured segments is inherently cyclical. Early delinquency indicators across the Indian banking system began ticking upward in late 2024, particularly in sub-Rs 50,000 personal loan tickets.

Jio Financial Services, backed by Reliance's capital, data ecosystem, and 450-million-plus telecom subscriber base, represents a structurally different kind of threat. If JFS replicates even a fraction of what Ant Financial achieved in China — embedding credit into commerce at the point of sale — the customer acquisition cost advantage that incumbent banks like HDFC enjoy erodes rapidly.

Indian banking history is littered with institutions that were once considered unassailable. Yes Bank collapsed into RBI-administered rescue in March 2020. IL&FS defaulted in September 2018 with Rs 91,000 crore in debt. DHFL was discovered to have siphoned thousands of crores through phantom accounts. HDFC Bank is not Yes Bank. But the lesson of Indian banking is that the phrase "it can't happen here" is itself the risk factor.

The bear case: LDR normalisation stalls, PSL costs persist, NIMs compress below 3.5%, unsecured retail delinquencies spike as the consumer cycle turns, and competitive intensity from JFS and ICICI Bank pressures both growth and pricing. ROA drifts toward 1.5% and the stock de-rates further to 2x book — implying 20–30% downside.

Investors should press management on: the quarter-by-quarter glide path for LDR normalisation, the all-in cost of PSL compliance, 30/60/90-day delinquency trends in the unsecured book disaggregated by vintage, technology infrastructure metrics the board monitors post-2020, the strategic response to Jio Financial Services, and what Aditya Puri would do differently if he were still in the chair.

6. Investment Checklist

- 1. Understandable Business:** **YES** HDFC Bank operates a straightforward retail and commercial banking model — accepting deposits, extending loans, and earning a net interest margin, supplemented by fee-based income from transaction banking, credit cards, and wealth management.
- 2. Durable Competitive Advantages (Widening Not Narrowing):** **YES** One of the strongest deposit franchises in India, built over three decades through superior technology, branch density, and service quality. The merger with HDFC Ltd significantly expanded the customer base, arguably widening the moat through cross-selling opportunities in mortgages.
- 3. Long Reinvestment Runway at High Returns:** **YES** India's credit-to-GDP ratio remains well below developed-market levels, and HDFC Bank holds only mid-single-digit market share in most lending categories. Structural growth in retail credit, SME lending, and mortgage penetration provide a multi-decade runway.
- 4. High Returns on Incremental Capital:** **YES** Pre-merger ROA of 1.8–2.0% and ROE of 16–18%, elite by global banking standards. The merger temporarily compressed these metrics, but management has a credible path to restore ROA toward 1.9–2.0% over the medium term.
- 5. Strong Free Cash Flow Generation:** **PARTIALLY** As a bank, traditional FCF analysis doesn't apply directly. However, low credit costs mean a high proportion of operating income flows to the bottom line. The bank has been internally generating sufficient capital to fund growth with infrequent equity dilution.
- 6. Conservative Balance Sheet:** **YES** Among the highest provision coverage ratios in Indian banking (70%+), conservative underwriting, and capital adequacy comfortably above regulatory minimums. Post-merger LDR is elevated but being actively managed down.
- 7. Aligned Management with Skin in the Game:** **PARTIALLY** CEO Jagdishan has meaningful ESOP holdings, but management ownership as a percentage of total market cap is modest given the bank's enormous size. The promoter structure has evolved post-merger.
- 8. Rational Capital Allocation History:** **YES** Disciplined — prioritising organic growth funded through internal accruals, conservative dividend payouts, and avoiding value-destructive acquisitions. The HDFC Ltd merger was a long-anticipated intra-group consolidation, not a speculative deal.
- 9. Favourable Industry Structure:** **YES** Indian banking has consolidated meaningfully, with well-run private banks steadily gaining share from weaker PSU banks. Regulatory barriers to entry are high, and scale confers real advantages. The industry structure favours disciplined, well-capitalised players.
- 10. Reasonable Valuation Relative to Quality and Growth:** **PARTIALLY** Post-merger dilution concerns have brought valuation down to roughly 2.5–3x trailing P/B. For a bank likely to deliver 14–17% ROE normalising toward 17–18%, this represents reasonable though not deeply compelling value.
- 11. Resilience to Recession or Disruption:** **YES** Conservative underwriting, diversified loan book, and strong provisioning buffers have navigated multiple cycles — demonetisation, the NBFC crisis, and COVID — with minimal asset quality deterioration relative to peers.
- 12. Transparent Management Communication:** **YES** Detailed quarterly disclosures, regular analyst presentations, and forthcoming commentary about post-merger integration challenges. Guidance has generally been conservative and met or exceeded over time.

Overall Assessment

HDFC Bank passes the quality investment checklist convincingly on most dimensions. It operates an understandable, high-return business with durable competitive advantages in a structurally attractive market with a long growth runway. The post-merger integration represents the key near-term variable — temporarily compressing returns and elevating the loan-to-deposit ratio — but management has a credible roadmap to restore pre-merger profitability within 2–3 years. At current valuations, HDFC Bank offers reasonable risk-reward for patient investors willing to underwrite the normalisation thesis, though it is not yet at a deep-value entry point.

7. Synthesis

The 3–4 Things That Matter Most

First, the HDFC Ltd merger is the defining event — and it cuts both ways. This is the largest transaction in Indian corporate history, and its success or failure will determine whether HDFC Bank emerges as a structurally stronger franchise or a diluted version of its former self. The bull case is compelling: absorb a Rs 6 lakh crore mortgage book, fund it with low-cost CASA deposits instead of wholesale borrowings, and create India's dominant housing finance and universal banking platform. The financial analysis confirms this is working directionally — deposit growth is tracking, high-cost borrowings are running off. But the Red Flags section correctly notes that the LDR remains above 110%, NIM compression is real, and PSL compliance costs are a multi-year drag. The merger is a 3-year integration story, and we are roughly halfway through. The trajectory is positive but not yet proven.

Second, this is the closest thing to a quality compounder in emerging market banking — but the valuation premium has collapsed for a reason. Pre-COVID, HDFC Bank traded at 4x book. Today it's 2.5–3x. The de-rating reflects three overlapping concerns: merger integration uncertainty, the leadership transition from Puri to Jagdishan, and FII selling driven by index rebalancing and emerging market rotation. The Investment Checklist scores 8 YES, 3 PARTIALLY, 0 NO — an outstanding result that places it alongside TSMC and above SK Hynix in business quality. But unlike TSMC (where geopolitics is the discount) or Tencent (where CCP risk is the discount), HDFC Bank's discount is largely execution-driven and therefore more within management's control to resolve. If NIM recovers toward 3.8–4.0% and ROA toward 1.9%, the stock re-rates. That's a fundamentals-driven catalyst, not a macro prayer.

Third, India's structural banking opportunity is genuinely exceptional — and HDFC Bank is the best vehicle to capture it. Credit-to-GDP at ~55% versus 150%+ in developed markets, a young and urbanising population, formalisation of the economy driving bank account penetration, and a regulatory framework that favours well-capitalised incumbents. The competitive analysis shows HDFC Bank's moat is real and defensible: 8,500 branches, 45%+ CASA ratio, sub-1.3% gross NPAs through cycles. No fintech or new entrant can replicate this deposit franchise from scratch. Jio Financial is the most credible threat, but even Reliance needs decades to build depositor trust.

Fourth, the unsecured retail cycle is the near-term wildcard. The Red Flags section identifies this correctly: India's consumer credit boom has driven rapid growth in personal loans and credit cards, and early delinquency indicators are ticking up. HDFC Bank's underwriting is better than peers, but no lender is immune to a systemic cycle. The bank's credit costs have been abnormally low; any normalisation directly hits profitability at a moment when NIM is already compressed from the merger.

Key Tensions and Contradictions

The most interesting tension is between the Checklist (which rates competitive advantages as "widening") and the Red Flags (which argues the stock's de-rating reflects genuine uncertainty about post-Puri execution). Both are valid. The franchise advantages — deposits, branches, underwriting culture — are structural and independent of any individual. But the market is pricing some probability that the cultural edge degrades under new leadership, and the merger's complexity provides cover for any slippage to be attributed to "integration" rather than capability decline.

A second tension: the Financial Characteristics section highlights that HDFC Bank's metrics are "top decile globally," while the Red Flags section notes that Indian banking history is "littered with institutions that were once considered unassailable." HDFC Bank is not Yes Bank — but the complacency warning is legitimate.

Open Questions for Further Research

1. **LDR trajectory:** What is the actual quarter-by-quarter deposit growth needed to reach 87% LDR by FY27? Is this achievable without pricing deposits aggressively (which would compress NIM)?
2. **Unsecured book quality:** What are 30/60/90 DPD trends in credit cards and personal loans by vintage? Is there a deterioration in recent vintages?
3. **Jio Financial reality check:** What is JFS's actual origination volume, customer base, and product stack as of today? Is it a real competitor or a narrative?
4. **Post-merger cross-sell:** Are HDFC Ltd mortgage customers actually opening CASA accounts and buying other bank products? What's the conversion rate?
5. **Technology investment:** Post the 2020 RBI ban, what specific infrastructure investments has the bank made, and how do uptime/outage metrics compare to pre-2020?

Quality Assessment

HDFC Bank is a **high-quality franchise in a temporarily messy transition**. The underlying business — India's strongest deposit-gathering machine with best-in-class underwriting in a structurally underpenetrated market — is exceptional. The merger creates a medium-term earnings headwind but a long-term strategic advantage. At 2.5–3x book with a clear path to 17%+ ROE, the risk-reward favours patient investors. This is not a deep bargain, but it's the rare opportunity to buy a genuinely world-class banking franchise at a cyclically depressed valuation. The key risk is not the business but the execution — and execution risk is exactly the kind of risk that rewards investors who do their homework.

Priority Next Steps

1. Obtain and analyse the last 3 quarters of earnings transcripts for deposit growth and LDR trajectory updates
2. Deep-dive on unsecured book asset quality — request vintage-level delinquency data
3. Build a NIM bridge model: legacy borrowing maturity schedule, incremental deposit cost, and yield on new origination
4. Assess Jio Financial Services' actual competitive position vs. narrative
5. Compare HDFC Bank post-merger metrics to ICICI Bank's post-cleanup trajectory for a relevant analogue

8. Learning Resources

Podcasts & Audio

- **Capitalmind Podcast** — Deepak Shenoy & team. Deep dives into Indian financial markets, banking sector analysis, and regulatory developments.
- **Marcellus Investment Managers — Consistent Compounders** — Saurabh Mukherjea & team. Frequently covers HDFC Bank as a core example of consistent compounding in India.
- **The Seen and the Unseen** — Amit Varma. Long-form Indian economics podcast covering banking regulation, RBI policy, and financial inclusion.
- **Paisa Vaisa** — Anupam Gupta. Indian personal finance and investing podcast with episodes on banking stocks and sector dynamics.

YouTube & Video

- **Shankar Nath** — Detailed fundamental analyses of Indian banking stocks including HDFC Bank, with walkthrough of financials.
- **Akshat Shrivastava** — Indian finance educator covering banking sector trends, HDFC Bank's merger, and competitive positioning.
- **NDTV Profit** — Post-earnings interviews with HDFC Bank management and analyst panels dissecting results.
- **HDFC Bank Investor Relations — Earnings Webcasts** — Primary source recordings of management commentary and analyst Q&A.

Books

- **"HDFC Bank 2.0: From Dawn to Digital"** — Tamal Bandyopadhyay — The definitive account of HDFC Bank's rise under Aditya Puri, covering strategy, culture, and digital transformation.
- **"Pandemonium: The Great Indian Banking Tragedy"** — Tamal Bandyopadhyay — Chronicles India's NPA crisis, contrasting failures of PSU banks with well-run private lenders like HDFC Bank.
- **"The Unusual Billionaires"** — Saurabh Mukherjea — Profiles Indian companies including HDFC Bank that sustained high ROE for a decade, with quality investing frameworks.

Long-Form Articles & Research

- **Tamal Bandyopadhyay's "Banker's Trust" column** — Livemint — Weekly insider perspective on Indian banking policy and institution-level analysis.
- **Marcellus Investment Managers — Research Notes** — Regular research featuring HDFC Bank as a case study in franchise value.
- **RBI Financial Stability Reports** — Semi-annual assessments of Indian banking system health, asset quality, and stress tests.
- **Aswath Damodaran — Emerging Market Bank Valuation** — NYU Stern professor's frameworks for valuing banks in emerging markets, directly applicable to HDFC Bank.

Earnings Calls & Primary Sources

- [HDFC Bank Investor Relations](#) — Annual reports, quarterly results, investor presentations, and press releases.
- [BSE India — HDFC Bank \(Code: 500180\)](#) — All regulatory filings, board outcomes, and shareholding patterns.
- [SEC EDGAR — HDFC Bank 20-F Filings](#) — US-listed ADR filings with detailed risk factors and GAAP reconciliations.
- [RBI Statistical Tables on Indian Banking](#) — Aggregate data on credit growth, deposits, sectoral NPAs, and PSL compliance.

Suggested Learning Path

Start with Tamal Bandyopadhyay's [HDFC Bank 2.0](#) for the institutional narrative. Read the latest [20-F filing](#) and [annual report](#) for current financials, especially post-merger dynamics. Supplement with Mukherjea's [The Unusual Billionaires](#) for a quality investing framework. Follow [Banker's Trust](#) and the [Capitalmind podcast](#) for ongoing sector context. Listen to at least two recent quarterly earnings calls. Finally, use [Damodaran's frameworks](#) to build your own valuation model.